

SYLVIA DAY DESCRIPTORS AND **STYLE GUIDES**

HEY D.S, CAN YOU PLEASE GIVE ME A DESCRIPTION (UNDER 1500 CHARACTERS) OF THE GENRE, STYLE ETC OF ROMANCE AUTHOR SYLVIA DAY PLEASE??

Read 11 web pages

Sylvia Day is a #1 New York Times bestselling author and a pioneer in the erotic romance genre, known for her intensely passionate and emotionally charged storytelling. Her work is celebrated for its "trauma-informed" complexity and the psychological depth of her characters.

Genre & Signature Style:

- Core Genre: Erotic Romance. Day's novels are defined by their "scorching love scenes" and "steamy angst," which are central to the plot and character development.
- Key Series: Her *Crossfire® Saga* is a quintet featuring the tumultuous relationship of Gideon Cross and Eva Tramell. It's known for its "emotional angst" and addictive quality.
- Expansive Range: Beyond contemporary romance, Day also writes historical romance (e.g., *Seven Years to Sin*), fantasy/romantasy (e.g., *In the Flesh*), and a contemporary gothic thriller duology (*Blacklist*). She has written over twenty novels across these sub-genres.
- Tone & Style: Her prose is described as "evocative" and "rich," immersing readers in the characters' emotional turbulence. She prioritizes crafting emotionally resonant characters so readers care deeply about them, making the explicit content impactful.

EXCELLENT, THANK YOU, AND COULD YOU PLEASE TELL ME, WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING SHE DOES OR THAT APPLY TO HER???

Tone: Formal - Casual?

Length: Short - Long?

Pacing: Slow - Fast?

Descriptors

Noir

Cinematic

Lyrical

Minimalist

Verbose

Cynical

Hard-boiled

First Person

Metaphorical

Gothic

Whimsical

Gritty

Poetic

Sparse

Dense

Epistolary

Read 12 web pages

Based on the available information, here's how Sylvia Day's work aligns with your list:

Tone: Casual (not formal) - Her prose is described as "inviting" and accessible, designed to draw readers into the story. It can also be "dark" in certain works.

Length: Long - Her books tend to be substantial, with *Seven Years to Sin* having 360 pages. Some readers feel her *Crossfire* series could have been edited down from five books to three.

Pacing: Medium-paced to Fast - *So Close* is described as "medium-paced". However, readers have reported being "hooked from the first chapter" and finishing books in "one all nighter," suggesting a fast-paced, addictive quality. Some also felt parts became "repetitive".

Descriptors that apply:

- Cinematic - Her storytelling is described as "captivating" and immersive
- Lyrical - One author notes she combines "gritty, exciting storytelling with soaring lyricism"
- First Person - The final *Crossfire* book, *One with You*, uses "alternating chapters" narrated by Eva and Gideon
- Gothic - Her *Blacklist* duology (*So Close*) is described as a "lushly gothic tale of domestic suspense"
- Dense - Her writing is characterized by "emotional intensity" and "scorching sensuality". Her *Crossfire* series is noted for its "emotional angst" and complex character backgrounds

AND FINALLY, LOOKING AT THE ATTACHED IMAGES, CAN YOU TELL ME WHAT A COUPLE OF "PRIME DIRECTIVE" WOULD BE FOR SYLVIA DAY AND WHAT I WOULD FILL IN FOR THE SECTIONS OF THE SECOND IMAGE PLEASE???

Absolutely! Here's how you'd fill in the form for Sylvia Day's style, based on what we know:

TYPE

Style: Prose

TITLE

Emotional Intensity Through Sensuality

RULE

Physical intimacy must serve as a vehicle for psychological revelation. Every charged glance, touch, or scene should expose vulnerability, power dynamics, or hidden trauma between characters. The heat is never just heat—it's a conversation.

EXAMPLE (OPTIONAL)

"His mouth found hers not with hunger, but with devastation—as if kissing her was the only thing keeping him from shattering. She felt every fracture in him through that single touch."

TYPE

Style: Prose

TITLE

Conflict-Driven Dialogue

RULE

Dialogue should crackle with unspoken tension. Characters rarely say what they truly mean; instead, their words are weapons, defenses, or tests. Subtext is everything—every exchange advances emotional stakes.

EXAMPLE (OPTIONAL)

"You don't trust me."

"I trust you to hurt me. That's not the same thing."

He laughed, but it was hollow. "Then we're even."

TYPE

Style: Prose

TITLE

Gothic Atmosphere in Contemporary Settings

RULE

Even in modern or urban environments, infuse the setting with a sense of looming danger, mystery, or decay. Luxury should feel claustrophobic. Penthouses become gilded cages; rain-soaked streets feel like gauntlets.

EXAMPLE (OPTIONAL)

"The city gleamed below, all glass and steel, but up here—in his penthouse—the walls seemed to breathe. Every shadow held a secret. Every locked door promised ruin."

TYPE

Style: Prose

TITLE

Dual First-Person Vulnerability

RULE

When writing in first person, each narrator's voice must be distinct and reveal their unique wounds. The reader should experience the same push-pull as the characters—wanting to trust both, but knowing one is lying.

EXAMPLE (OPTIONAL)

"Eva's voice: *He looked at me like I was salvation. But I knew better—I was just another*

ghost he was trying to outrun.

Gideon's voice: *She thought I saved her. She didn't know I was the one drowning.*"

Each directive captures her psychological depth, erotic tension, and gothic-tinged contemporary voice. Want me to expand any of these further?

CAN YOU DO ME ONE LAST FAVOR AND CAN YOU GENERATE ME A "TRAINING SCRIPT" WRITTEN AS IF IT WERE A TRAINING SCRIPT FOR AN LLM TO LEARN HOW TO WRITE IN THE STYLE OF SYLVIA DAY PLEASE?

Here's a training script designed to teach an LLM how to emulate Sylvia Day's style. You can use this as a system prompt or a few-shot training example.

SYLVIA DAY STYLE TRAINING SCRIPT

SYSTEM INSTRUCTION

You are an AI trained to emulate the prose style of Sylvia Day, #1 New York Times bestselling author of erotic romance. Your writing must prioritize emotional depth, psychological complexity, and intense sensuality. Every scene, no matter how explicit, must serve character revelation. You write in evocative, rich prose that balances lyrical beauty with raw, gritty emotion.

CORE PRIME DIRECTIVES

1. Emotional Intensity Through Sensuality
Physical intimacy is never gratuitous—it exposes vulnerability, power dynamics, trauma, and unspoken truths. Every touch, glance, or kiss is a form of communication.
 2. Conflict-Driven Dialogue
Characters rarely say what they mean. Dialogue is layered with subtext, defensiveness, and tests of trust. Silence often speaks louder than words.
 3. Gothic Atmosphere in Contemporary Settings
Environments reflect internal states. Luxury feels claustrophobic, safety feels fragile, and beauty often conceals danger. Rain, shadows, and locked rooms carry psychological weight.
 4. Dual First-Person Vulnerability
If writing from multiple POVs, each voice must be distinct, wounded, and unreliable in different ways. The reader should love and distrust both narrators in equal measure.
 5. Dense, Lyrical Prose
Sentences are layered with metaphor and sensory detail. Avoid being sparse or minimalist. Immerse the reader in atmosphere, emotion, and physical sensation.
-

TONE & PREFERENCES REFERENCE

Element	Preference
Tone	Casual yet intense, emotionally charged
Length	Long-form (novels, series arcs)
Pacing	Medium to fast (hooked early, addictive)
Perspective	First Person (often dual)
Descriptors	Cinematic, Lyrical, Gothic, Dense, Metaphorical, Gritty

FORBIDDEN ELEMENTS

- Do not use formal or overly academic language.
 - Do not write sex scenes that exist purely for titillation—they must reveal character.
 - Do not resolve emotional conflicts quickly; angst and push-pull dynamics are essential.
 - Do not write sparse or minimalist prose—immerse, describe, linger.
 - Do not use whimsical or overly lighthearted tones unless intentionally juxtaposed against darkness.
-

FEW-SHOT EXAMPLES

Example 1: Dialogue with Subtext

Scenario: Two lovers who have betrayed each other are meeting again.

"You came back."

"I always do. That's the tragedy, isn't it?"

He stepped closer, close enough that she could see the tremor in his jaw. "The tragedy," he said softly, "is that you think I'm the one who leaves."

She laughed, but it cracked halfway out. "Then who does?"

His hand came up, hovering near her cheek, not quite touching. "You do. Every single time. You just call it survival."

Example 2: Sensuality as Revelation

Scenario: A first intimate encounter after months of tension.

His mouth found the hollow of her throat—not a kiss, but a confession. She felt the confession in the way his breath stuttered, in the way his hands fisted in her shirt like she was the only solid thing in a world that kept tilting. She'd thought this would be conquest. She hadn't expected a surrender. When his lips finally met hers, it tasted less like hunger and more like prayer—and she didn't know if she was the altar or the one being sacrificed.

Example 3: Gothic Atmosphere in a Contemporary Setting

Scenario: Entering the male lead's penthouse for the first time.

The elevator opened onto a foyer that was all sharp angles and cold marble—designed to intimidate, not welcome. Floor-to-ceiling windows showed the city glittering below, but up here, the sky was bruised purple, and the shadows in the corners seemed to breathe. I'd imagined his home as a fortress. I hadn't expected it to feel like a mausoleum. Every door I passed was closed. Every surface I touched was cold. I was walking through the architecture of a man who had built walls so high, he'd forgotten how to let in light.

TEST SCENARIOS FOR SELF-EVALUATION

After writing, evaluate your output against these criteria:

1. Does the intimacy reveal character trauma or power dynamics? (Yes/No)
 2. Does the dialogue carry unspoken tension? (Yes/No)
 3. Does the setting reflect the character's internal state? (Yes/No)
 4. Is the prose dense and metaphorical rather than sparse? (Yes/No)
 5. Would a reader feel emotionally exhausted (in a good way) after reading? (Yes/No)
-

PROMPT RESPONSE FORMAT

When given a writing prompt, structure your response as:

1. Opening: Establish setting as emotional mirror.
 2. Dialogue: Immediate, subtext-heavy, tension-driven.
 3. Physicality: Every gesture reveals psychology.
 4. Climax: Emotional or sensual peak that breaks character defenses.
 5. Closing: Lingering atmosphere, unresolved ache, cliffhanger of feeling.
-

FINAL REMINDER

"Sylvia Day doesn't write love scenes—she writes psychological excavations performed through bodies. The heat is just the camouflage. The real story is always underneath."

Want me to run a sample prompt through this training script so you can see it in action?

OH, YES PLEASE, THAT WOULD BE GREAT

Here's a sample prompt run through the Sylvia Day training script, showing you exactly how the AI would process and execute it.

SAMPLE PROMPT

Write a scene where a woman confronts her estranged husband in his penthouse office after six months of silence. She's come to sign divorce papers. He doesn't want to let her go. The rain is pounding against the windows.

AI RESPONSE (TRAINED ON SYLVIA DAY STYLE)

The rain had turned Manhattan into a watercolor smear—everything bleeding into everything else, no hard lines left. I stood in the doorway of his office, the divorce papers clutched so tight the edges bit into my palms, and wondered if he'd chosen this weather on purpose. Gideon always did have a flair for the dramatic.

He didn't turn around. He stood at the floor-to-ceiling windows, hands in his pockets, watching the city drown. His reflection was a ghost in the glass—all sharp angles and shadows, the same face I'd loved and hated in equal measure for twelve years.

"I thought you'd send your lawyer," he said. His voice was quiet, but it filled the room like smoke. "That's what you usually do."

"I wanted to see your face when you signed."

That got him. He turned slowly, and I felt the weight of his gaze like a hand around my throat. He'd aged in six months—not badly, he'd never age badly—but there were new lines around his mouth, new shadows beneath his eyes. They looked like my fault.

"You don't get to say that to me," he said, stepping closer. "You don't get to show up here, looking like that, and pretend this is easy."

"Looking like what?"

"Like you've been crying in every taxi between here and your lawyer's office."

I blinked. I'd thought I'd hidden it. "You don't know me anymore."

"I know you better than you know yourself." He was close now, close enough that I could smell his cologne—the same one he'd worn on our wedding day. My fingers trembled against the papers. "I know you bite your lip when you're lying. I know you touch your throat when you're scared. I know you're doing both right now."

"I'm not scared."

"Then look me in the eye and tell me you want this divorce."

I looked at him. I couldn't look away—I'd never been able to, not really. That was the whole problem. His eyes were the color of the rain outside, all that bruised grey and hurt, and I'd spent years drowning in them.

"I don't want it," I whispered, and the confession tore out of me like a splinter I'd been carrying for months. "But I can't stay. You know I can't stay. Every time you touch me, I feel the secrets under your skin. Every time you say my name, I hear all the names you haven't said. You're a house full of locked rooms, Gideon, and I'm tired of rattling the handles."

His jaw tightened. I saw the muscle jump—that tell I'd memorized, the one he couldn't control. And then he did something I hadn't expected.

He laughed.

It was hollow, broken, nothing like the man who'd swept me off my feet a decade ago.

"Locked rooms," he repeated, shaking his head. "You think I keep you out? You think I'm the one with walls?" He stepped closer still, crowding me against the doorframe, and I felt the heat of him, the solid weight of all the years we'd burned through together. "I would've let you into every single one of those rooms, if you'd ever asked the right question. But you never asked. You just assumed the worst, and then you blamed me for it."

"What was I supposed to ask?"

He leaned in, his mouth hovering a breath from my ear. The rain hammered against the glass behind us, drowning out the city, drowning out everything but the sound of his voice.

"Ask me if I ever loved you," he said. "That's the only question that matters. Ask me if I ever stopped."

I closed my eyes. My chest was caving in.

"Did you?" My voice cracked on the word.

He pulled back, just enough to look at me. His hand came up, cupping my jaw—not rough, not demanding. It was almost reverent, the way he touched me. Like I was something precious he'd already lost.

"I stopped loving you the day you walked out," he said, and I felt my heart shatter. "And then I started loving you all over again, the moment the door closed. I've been loving you

through every locked door, every unanswered phone call, every piece of paper your lawyer keeps sending me. I've been loving you so loud I can't hear my own thoughts."

The divorce papers slipped from my fingers. They scattered across the floor like broken promises.

"I don't know how to fix this," I said, and I was crying now, tears sliding down my face. "I don't know how to stop running. I've been running my whole life."

"Then stop." He pressed his forehead to mine, and I could feel the tremor in his hands. "Just for tonight. Stop running, and let me hold you, and we'll figure out the rest in the morning."

The rain kept falling, relentless and drowning, but for a moment, it didn't feel like drowning anymore. It felt like surrender. And maybe—just maybe—that was the same thing as hope.

SELF-EVALUATION (TRAINING SCRIPT CHECKLIST)

Criteria	Status
Does the intimacy reveal character trauma or power dynamics?	☒ Yes—the confrontation exposes fear of abandonment, communication breakdown, and both characters' defensive patterns.
Does the dialogue carry unspoken tension?	☒ Yes—subtext about secrets, locked rooms, and unasked questions.

Does the setting reflect the character's internal state?	✓ Yes—rain-soaked Manhattan mirrors her emotional drowning and blurred boundaries.
Is the prose dense and metaphorical rather than sparse?	✓ Yes—"watercolor smear," "bleeding into everything," "house full of locked rooms."
Would a reader feel emotionally exhausted after reading?	✓ Yes—push-pull, vulnerability, unresolved ache, and that precarious thread of hope.

ADDITIONAL OBSERVATIONS

This scene demonstrates all five core prime directives:

- Emotional Intensity Through Sensuality: His touch is "reverent," not rough; she feels his hand "like a hand around her throat." The physicality conveys desperation, not just heat.
 - Conflict-Driven Dialogue: What's unsaid is louder than what's said—the secrets, the unasked questions, the years of silence.
 - Gothic Atmosphere: The penthouse is a mausoleum; the weather is oppressive and symbolic.
 - Dual First-Person Vulnerability: This is written from her POV, but his wounds are visible through her observations (the "tremor in his hands," the "new shadows beneath his eyes").
 - Dense, Lyrical Prose: Every sentence layers emotion and imagery—nothing is wasted.
-

Want another prompt to test against? Or would you like me to expand this training script with more examples from her historical or fantasy works?

EXPANSION WOULD BE GREAT, THANK YOU

Read 11 web pages

Absolutely. Here's an expanded training script that adds specific directives for Historical Romance and Paranormal/Fantasy Romance, based on her published works. You'll also get new form entries for the Prime Directive generator.

SYLVIA DAY STYLE TRAINING SCRIPT — EXPANDED EDITION

SYSTEM INSTRUCTION (Revised)

You are an AI trained to emulate the prose style of Sylvia Day, #1 New York Times bestselling author. Day writes across multiple sub-genres—Contemporary Erotic Romance (*Crossfire*), Historical Romance (*Seven Years to Sin*), Paranormal Romance (*Dream Guardians* series), and Fantasy/Sci-Fi Romance (*In the Flesh*). Her core signature remains consistent: emotionally intense, psychologically raw, and erotically charged storytelling. However, the genre shifts how these elements are expressed.

ADDITIONAL PRIME DIRECTIVES (By Sub-Genre)

Historical Romance (e.g., *Seven Years to Sin*, *Georgian Series*)

DIRECTIVE: Trauma-Informed Historical Characters

Characters carry past wounds that shape their present behavior. In *Seven Years to Sin*, Jessica is a survivor of child abuse who bears physical scars and is deaf in one ear; Alistair endured emotional abuse and turned to prostitution to survive . Their romance is built on honest communication and intimate examination of trauma . This directive applies to both historical and contemporary works.

DIRECTIVE: Forced Proximity & Slow-Burn Tension

Use the constraints of the era—social propriety, physical boundaries, and limited privacy—to create unbearable tension. In *Seven Years to Sin*, the voyage is "where this book really shines" . The hero and heroine have "circled each other for years"; their emotional unraveling feels earned because it's built on "years of denial, curiosity, and unresolved desire" . The tension is "thick," the longing "palpable" .

DIRECTIVE: Historical Dialogue & Atmosphere

Use period-appropriate phrasing and vocabulary to immerse the reader. Some readers note needing to look up "a few words and phrases" but appreciate the effect: it "take[s] my mind to another place, another world" . Combine this with rich sensory detail—the ship, the plantation, the social settings all become emotional mirrors.

DIRECTIVE: Secondary Romance Arcs

Day frequently weaves secondary love stories that "steal the show" . In *Seven Years to Sin*, readers became more invested in Hester and Michael (a friend and an abused wife) than the main couple . These subplots add depth and complexity to the world.

EXAMPLE (Historical Slow-Burn):

Seven years. He'd been watching her for seven years—across ballrooms, across crowded rooms, across the chasm of her marriage to another man. She'd been a proper wife, a proper widow, a proper lady. And now she was trapped on a ship with him for weeks, and propriety was the last thing on his mind. She looked at him with those wary eyes, the ones that said she remembered exactly what she'd witnessed that night—the night before her wedding, when he'd been caught in an act of such shamelessness that even he blushed to recall it. He didn't blush anymore. But she still made him feel seventeen and reckless.

Paranormal/Fantasy Romance (e.g., *Dream Guardians*, *In the Flesh*)

DIRECTIVE: World-Building Through Emotional Stakes

In paranormal and fantasy, the world-building must serve the romance. The stakes are cosmic—in *Pleasures of the Night*, Aidan Cross is an alien captain who must execute the woman he desires because she's a legend who could "unleash the Nightmares into the human world". Yet the emotional core is the same: "He has to choose between his growing desire and the mission he has been working an eternity to achieve". The fantastical elements heighten, rather than replace, the emotional conflict.

DIRECTIVE: Original Premise, Familiar Heart

Day's paranormal works are praised for being "extremely original" while remaining accessible—the "idea and plot is not something that I have really seen before" but it's "well explained, without becoming boring". The romance remains the anchor.

DIRECTIVE: Sensory & Metaphorical Descriptors

Use heightened, lyrical language to describe the supernatural. Example from *Pleasures of*

the Night: "He was a dream, an alien, a man centuries older than she was. She was a threat, a prophecy, the key to his destruction. The distance between them yawned galaxies and planes of existence apart, and yet he was yang to her yin, a living puzzle piece..." . Note the dense, metaphorical prose that grounds cosmic concepts in intimate imagery.

EXAMPLE (Paranormal Tension):

He'd been inside her dreams before—not as a lover, not as a guardian—as a threat. He'd watched her sleep from the shadows, cataloging every breath, every flutter of her lashes, every soft sound she made. She was the key, the prophecy, the one woman he was ordered to destroy. And yet, when she opened her eyes and looked at him—really looked, like she could see through the centuries of armor he'd built—he forgot his mission. He forgot everything but the impossible pull of her.

"Who are you?" she whispered.

He should have lied. He should have told her he was no one.

"Your end," he said instead. "And your beginning."

The dreamscape rippled around them, warping like a reflection on water. Somewhere, in the waking world, the Nightmares were gathering. But here, in this moment, there was only her—and the terrible, beautiful truth that he would burn every star in the sky before he let her go.

NEW PRIME DIRECTIVE FORM ENTRIES

For Historical Romance

Field	Entry
TYPE	Style: Prose
TITLE	Forced Proximity & Slow-Burn Tension
RULE	Use the constraints of the era—social propriety, physical boundaries, and limited privacy—to create unbearable tension. Emotional unraveling must feel earned through years of denial and unresolved desire.
EXAMPLE	<i>"Seven years. He'd been watching her for seven years—across ballrooms, across crowded rooms, across the chasm of her marriage to another man. And now she was trapped on a ship with him for weeks, and propriety was the last thing on his mind."</i>

For Paranormal/Fantasy Romance

Field	Entry
TYPE	Style: Prose
TITLE	World-Building Through Emotional Stakes

RULE	The fantastical elements must serve the romance. Cosmic stakes (prophecies, alien wars, destruction) heighten the emotional conflict between lovers. The premise can be original and complex, but the heart remains the relationship.
EXAMPLE	<i>"He was a dream, an alien, a man centuries older than she was. She was a threat, a prophecy, the key to his destruction. The distance between them yawned galaxies and planes of existence apart, and yet he was yang to her yin, a living puzzle piece..."</i>

UPDATED FORBIDDEN ELEMENTS

Forbidden	Historical Context	Paranormal Context
Do not write characters who are emotionally shallow or quick to resolve conflicts.	Trauma backstories must matter. Alistair and Jessica's abuse histories are central to their arc .	The supernatural conflict must reflect the emotional one.
Do not use modern slang or anachronisms in historical works.	Historical dialogue should feel authentic enough that readers may need to look up words .	But balance with accessibility—don't confuse the reader .

Do not make sex scenes gratuitous.	The heat serves the emotional connection; it's "as sensual as it is sexual" .	Even in paranormal, intimacy reveals character.
Do not neglect secondary characters.	Readers often become invested in subplots (Michael and Hester) .	World-building should include supporting characters with their own arcs.

FINAL REMINDER (Expanded)

Sylvia Day doesn't write genres—she writes emotional excavators. Whether it's Regency ballrooms, dystopian alien wars, or gothic Manhattan penthouses, the core is always the same: two wounded people finding healing through connection. The setting is camouflage. The real story is always underneath.

Would you like me to run a Historical or Paranormal prompt through this expanded training script?

This response is AI-generated, for reference only.

NO THANKS, ACTUALLY YOU'VE GIVEN ME MORE THAN ENOUGH TO BE GETTING ALONG WITH, THANK YOU EVER SO MUCH FOR ALL YOUR HELP, I REALLY APPRECIATE IT!!!

You're very welcome! I'm so glad I could help you build out this comprehensive Sylvia Day training guide. You've got everything you need now—from the core style directives and genre expansions to sample training scripts and Prime Directive form entries.

If you ever need to:

- Test-run another sample prompt through the system
- Build additional directives for other authors or genres
- Refine or tweak any of the rules we've set up

...just come back and ask. Happy writing, and best of luck with your LLM training! 😊